Lab 00 — Before Class

About twenty minutes at home. Do this and you walk in ready to build.

Introduction

Our class together is two hours, and nearly all of it is for thinking and building. None of it should be spent installing software or waiting for downloads.

So everything in this guide happens **before** you arrive. Five steps, about twenty minutes, and most of that is waiting for things to download.

- **All guides and materials:** gcodekhanna1.github.io/2026-11-enas-agentic-lab
- **One laptop per table.** Your table will build on a single laptop, and you don't yet know whose. So **everyone does this setup** — the person driving needs it to work, and somebody needs to take over when their battery dies.

> ⚠️ **These instructions are for a Mac. If you'll be bringing a Windows laptop, email us before class and we'll send you the equivalent steps. Don't leave it until the day.**

What You'll Need

- **Your Mac**, with permission to install software on it.
- **Your lab account.** You'll get an email with a `demo-xx` account assigned to you. Claude's sign-in link gets forwarded to the address you normally read, so there's no new mailbox to check.
- **Your own email**, open, to click that link.
- **About twenty minutes**, most of it waiting.

What You're Installing, and Why

Two things, both free.

- **The Claude desktop app** — what you'll build with. Not the website: the app, because it can work with files and folders on your own machine.

- **uv** — a tool that installs Python and whatever libraries an app needs, keeping each project's setup separate and tidy. You won't type `uv` commands during the workshop. The app you build uses it behind the scenes, and installing it now means nothing has to download while the class clock is running.

Step 01: Create a Folder for Your Project

> ⚠️ **Create this folder in your home folder — the one with your user name. Do NOT put it in iCloud Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive, Box or Google Drive, and not on your Desktop or in Documents unless you're certain those aren't syncing. While Claude builds, it writes thousands of small files, and a sync app trying to upload them at the same time will break the build. This is the single most common thing that goes wrong.**

- In Finder, press **⌘ + Shift + H**. Your home folder opens — it's the one named after you, something like `/Users/yourname`.
- Choose **File → New Folder**.
- Name it something you'll recognise, such as `ENAS 2170 Project`.
- **Quick check:** click the folder once and press **⌘ + I**. If the "Where" line mentions iCloud, Dropbox, OneDrive, Box or Google Drive, move it to your home folder.

Step 02: Install the Claude Desktop App

- Download it from claude.com/download and choose the **macOS** version.
- Open the downloaded file and drag Claude into your **Applications** folder.
- **Already have it?** Open it and let it update to the latest version.

Step 03: Install uv

This one happens in Terminal, which is a window where you type commands instead of clicking. You'll use it once here and probably never again during the workshop.

- Open Terminal: press **⌘ + Space**, type `Terminal`, and press **Return**.

- Copy this line, paste it into the Terminal window, and press **Return**:

```
curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh
```

- Wait for it to finish. You'll see a few lines of progress and then your prompt returns.
- **Now close Terminal completely** (**⌘ + Q**) and open it again. This matters — `uv` isn't available in a window that was already open before you installed it.
- Check it worked. Type this and press **Return**:

```
uv --version
```

- You should see a version number, something like `uv 0.9.x`. If you do, you're done with Terminal.

> Pasting a command you don't understand into a terminal is a reasonable thing to be cautious about. This one downloads the official installer from astral.sh, the company that makes uv, and installs it in your own user account — it doesn't need an administrator password and doesn't touch the rest of your Mac.

Step 04: Sign In to Your Lab Account

- Open the Claude desktop app.
- Sign in with the `demo-xx@paradigmventures.ai` address from the email we sent you.
- Claude emails you a sign-in link. **It arrives in your own inbox**, because your lab account forwards to the address you registered with.
- Open that link **on the same Mac** you're signing in from.

[PLACEHOLDER - screenshot of the Claude sign-in screen]

Step 05: Check That It Works

- In the Claude desktop app, switch to **Cowork** using the control at the top of the sidebar.
- Start a **+ New** session.

- Connect it to the folder you made in Step 01.
- Type a short message — `Hello, can you see my project folder?` — and check that Claude answers and names your folder back to you.

That's it. If that worked, you're set until class.

[PLACEHOLDER - screenshot of a working Cowork session with the project folder connected]

If Something Doesn't Work

Email us **before class**. Every one of these takes a minute to fix beforehand and eats your build time on the day.

- **The sign-in email never arrives:** check your spam folder, then tell us. The forwarding may need fixing at our end.
- `uv --version` **says "command not found":** you probably checked in the same Terminal window you installed from. Quit Terminal with **⌘ + Q**, open it fresh, and try again.
- **You can't install software on your Mac:** tell us and we'll arrange something.
- **Claude can't see your folder:** check it isn't in a synced location — see the warning in Step 01.

What's Next

In class your table picks **one** of two projects and builds it together:

- **Lab 02 — Internship, Discovery and Planner**
- **Lab 03 — Portfolio and Budget Tracker**

Have a look if you're curious, but don't start building. The first part of the workshop is a conversation with your table, laptops mostly shut — and that conversation is what makes the build work.